

Bhargava agrees that other companies are realising the importance of gaming and could be bigger competitors on the global stage: "The race is for intellectual property. We have the rights to Jean Claude van Damme for two games that can be sold globally. Similarly, other companies could have rights to other stars or actors."

While other Indian companies create and sell about 70 per cent of their games internationally, Paradox sells almost 90 per cent of their wares in the global marketplace.

Tech Talk

With the increase of Java-based mobile phone handsets in India, most of the games being churned out are, naturally, based on this platform. But BREW, we believe, is the next big thing waiting to happen. "We are already creating BREW games for Hutch in Thailand so we won't be off-guard when it's time to do that elsewhere," says Bhargava.

Gondal agrees. Tata Teleservices has launched BREW-based games in India: "BREW has a better business model and also receives better support from Qualcomm. With Java, there is no standardisation, since there are so many vendors for it. In fact, in Japan, even Flash Lite has caught on for games on mobile phones."

But Hiranandani has a different opinion on this. He believes BREW is "not gonna happen". "Right now, almost 80 per cent of the gaming content is in Java, and given the spread—existing and

? Most-Popular Games

- ☐ Cricket World Championship
- ☐ Spider-Man
- ☐ Munnabhai MBBS
- ☐ The Fast And The Furious
- ☐ Van Helsing
- ☐ Sholay
- ☐ Speedforge
- ☐ The Day After Tomorrow
- ☐ Main Hoon Na
- ☐ Teen Patti

future—of Java-based phones, BREW will not be such a significant player," he says.

Laws And Legality

In a country such as India that can be best described as a lawless haven for Intellectual Property Rights and cyber-laws, these companies are taking it unto themselves with the help of regulatory bodies such as the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) to maintain the sanctity of their property.

Recently, Indigames took a competitor to court for allegedly copying the source code of one of their popular cricket games. The action sent a warning signal that stealing is not acceptable.

"The smaller outfits, or what could best be described as mom-and-pop shops, will not survive. It's not just about money but also about protecting whatever you have created," says Gondal. Bhargava and Hiranandani concur.

Future-Ready

As with computer games, the future of mobile gaming, too, is with multiplayer and 3D gaming. In Japan and Korea, multiplayer gaming is already big, and community gaming is catching on. "3G networks will fuel the rise of multiplayer gaming and give the industry its next big thing," says Gondal. Reliance is already offering three multiplayer games, and is adding more shortly, confirming this trend.

While mobility changed the way we worked and lived, mobile gaming may just change the way we entertain ourselves. Are you connected? ■

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